

Emirates Questions

Wednesday, 17 June 2026 14:01



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Pearson Edexcel International Advanced Level
Business / Unit 3: Strategic Position and Strategic Choices

WBS13/01 — Practice Paper: Emirates (Topic 3.3 PESTLE)

QUESTION PAPER

Centre Number

Candidate Number

Candidate Name

Instructions to Candidates

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Fill in the boxes at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- Answer ALL questions in Sections A, B and C.
- Write your answers in the spaces provided.
- You must use the Source Booklet when answering questions.

Information

- The total mark for this paper is 60.
- The marks for each question are shown in brackets, for example (4).
- You are advised to spend approximately 30 minutes on Section A, 25 minutes on Section B and 25 minutes on Section C.

SECTION A

Read Extracts A, B, C and D in the Source Booklet before answering Question 1.

Write your answers in the spaces provided.

- 1 (a)** Using Extract B, calculate to two decimal places the operating profit margin for the Emirates Group in 2023–24. You are advised to show your working. **(4)**

Working:

Operating profit margin = _____

- (b)** Using Extract C, explain one way in which a political factor is currently acting as a threat to Emirates' strategic objectives. **(4)**

- (c)** Using Extracts A and D, discuss whether the strong growth in passenger numbers is sufficient evidence that Emirates' current strategy is succeeding. **(8)**

You should consider arguments on both sides.

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(d) Using Extracts A, B and C, assess the likely impact of political and economic PESTLE factors on Emirates' ability to achieve its strategic objectives.

(12)

In your answer you should:

- analyse how political factors affect Emirates' operations and objectives
- analyse how economic factors affect Emirates' operations and objectives
- reach a judgement about which type of factor has the greater impact.

Total for
Question =
Total for
Question 1 = 28
marks marks

SECTION B

Read Extracts E and F in the Source Booklet before answering Question 2.

Write your answer in the space provided.

2 Evaluate the extent to which environmental factors represent the most significant external influence on Emirates' strategic decisions. (20)

A/A* Guidance: To reach Level 4 (17–20 marks) your answer must:

- analyse environmental factors with specific evidence from the sources
- compare the relative significance of environmental factors against at least ONE other PESTLE category
- acknowledge an alternative viewpoint or counter-argument
- reach a justified evaluative conclusion — not just 'it depends'

Total for
Question =
Total for
Question 2 = 20
marks marks

SECTION C

Read Extract G in the Source Booklet before answering Question 3.

Write your answer in the space provided.

"PESTLE analysis may be a useful starting point for strategic thinking, but in a highly volatile industry such as aviation, it offers little more than an organised list of things that managers already know."

3 Evaluate the view that PESTLE analysis offers limited value to the strategic management of a multinational airline such as Emirates.

(20)

A/A* Guidance: Structure your answer around:

- arguments FOR the view (limitations of PESTLE in volatile environments)
- arguments AGAINST the view (strategic value of systematic external analysis)
- interaction effects between PESTLE factors — reference Extract G
- a justified conclusion that considers conditions under which PESTLE is more or less valuable

Total for
Question =
Total for
Question 3 = 20
marks marks

TOTAL FOR PAPER = 60 MARKS

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